

AIDS

You educate, support people to get tested and stay on treatment, and fight stigma. Above all, keep everyone's information private.

For health workers

Key messages

- All pregnant women should be tested for HIV and syphilis at ANC. Explain the steps of ePTCT: take medicine regularly, give birth at the facility, the baby gets medicine within 72 hours, only breast milk for six months, the baby is tested at 6 weeks and 18 months.
- Never share confidential information, even with the person's spouse, family or your own family. Share only with their health worker or your supervisor when needed.
- Fight stigma: educate the community, correct myths, encourage support, and be a role model. Stigma stops people getting

tested and treated.

- Support clients: help them find a treatment supporter, watch for side effects, encourage them to keep taking ART, and remind them they can live a long normal life.
- Trace clients who stop coming for medicine, confidentially and only if they have agreed to your support.
- Encourage good food, and discourage alcohol and smoking. Encourage partners to be tested.
- Link clients to the health facility when needed. Watch for signs of depression and seek help.

Refer if a person has

- Not started or stopped ART
- Long fever, diarrhoea or weight loss
- A cough of two weeks or more (possible TB)
- Signs of depression or thoughts of self-harm

Run a village session

- 1.** Meet in a shaded, central place at a time when families can come. Greet everyone and say what today's topic is.
- 2.** Ask what people already know and what they have heard. Listen first.
- 3.** Share three key messages from this page in your local language. Use pictures and real examples from the village.
- 4.** Ask people to say the messages back in their own words, and answer questions.
- 5.** Agree on one action the village will take this month. Refer anyone who is unwell, and record who came.

General information only. Follow the advice of your health centre and current national guidelines. Based on the National Department of Health Village Health Assistant (VHA) training curriculum.